



Tesla Model S up in flames

A Model S burst in flames in a parking lot in Shanghai, Tesla has sent a team to investigate.
<https://digit.in/may19-13>



Galaxy Fold launch delayed

After the Galaxy Fold breaks in the hands of reviewers, Samsung delays launch
<https://digit.in/may19-14>

part of that larger offering – a simple on-demand communication link between the security desk and your flat. This is exactly what we're going to help you achieve – a way to MacGyver your own e-intercom system using (hopefully) things you have lying around. Here's how to do it:

STEP 1:

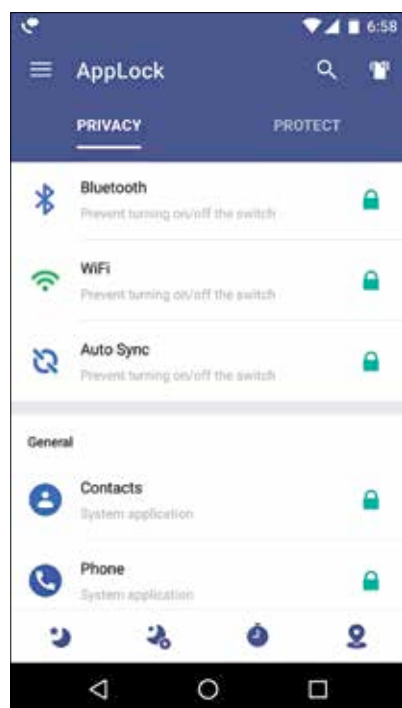
Procure an old smartphone or tablet, preferably one that is running at least Android 5.0 Lollipop and factory reset it if needed. Pop in a spare LTE capable SIM (you most likely have one from the Jio era lying around) or if possible, arrange for WiFi at the gate.

STEP 2:

Create a common email address (It HAS to be Gmail since a Google account is required) for the entire apartment block that can be used for the administrator account and set up the phone with it.

STEP 3:

Download AppLock and set it up with a lock pattern/password. Using this app you need to put the phone on complete lockdown. Start with tog-



Lock everything down

gling on the "Prevent installing and uninstalling" feature under Play Store so that no new apps can be installed or uninstalled. Next toggle the "Prevent WiFi toggle" lock. Scroll on below and lock Contacts, Settings and Phone system apps as well. Locking phone and contacts will still let the phone receive calls, just not place them. Then switch to the right tab (you can find it a little below the top of the screen) and navigate to the General settings. Turn on Advanced Protection by downloading the required app for it. This will ensure that the user can't force stop or uninstall the AppLock app itself. Locking down everything ensures the phone will only be used for e-intercom duties and nothing else.

STEP 4:

Download Find My Device and log into it with the Google account you made in Step 2 and make sure that your device is ringable and locatable with another phone or laptop. To do this from another phone, you need the same app and select the 'Log in as a guest' option. To test from a PC, navigate to <https://myaccount.google.com/find-your-phone> or just google 'Find My Phone' from a browser while you are logged into the same Google account. This step ensures the phone never gets misplaced or 'stolen'.

STEP 5:

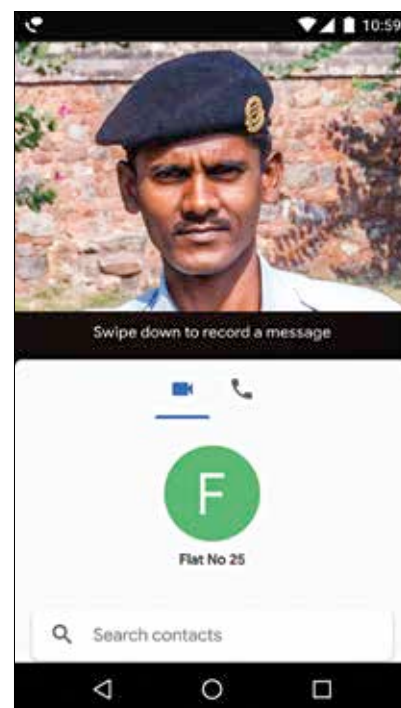
Store the phone numbers of the house owners as contacts with their house numbers as the names for simplicity.

STEP 6:

Download Google Duo, if it isn't pre-installed on the phone already. Click on the 'Options' icon on the top right and make sure that the 'Knock Knock' feature is turned on. Now the residents can look at the video without actually having to pick up the call, especially if they want to ensure their own privacy. Optionally, you can also use something like WhatsApp (to avoid learning curve) or Vower Walkie Talkie Messenger (for a less invasive solution), but we find that Duo works best.

STEP 7:

Take the time to train your security guard through how to use Duo and some basic technical troubleshooting like making sure the mobile data is turned on if the calls don't go through. Walk them through a few likely scenarios and make sure they understand



A mockup of how the setup might look

what everything does, especially highlighting the Find My Phone feature as it'll form a deterrent against deliberate misplacement. Also make sure to teach them how to leave video messages for times when you can't pick up the call but would still like to know who visited when you weren't around or have visual confirmation of a package being dropped off.

And voila, you have yourselves a limited but effective e-intercom system that is way cheaper than any professional solution. But then again, you do get what you pay for. For a small apartment complex comprising of maybe one to two buildings and a single main gate, this DIY solution should be more than sufficient. Of course, for situations that warrant something more capable and complex, you can always avail better solutions. 